New Zealand Rogaining Association (Inc) **20th January 2005**
http://www.rogaine.org.nz/

NZRA Newsletter - January 2005

The next major event on the rogaining calendar is –

> **The Nenthorn Nemesis – New Zealand Rogaining Championships**
> 26th – 27th February, 2005
> Middlemarch, Central Otago

The New Zealand Championship 24hr event starts at midday Saturday, and there will be a non-championship 6hr event from 1pm to 7pm Saturday. Course setter Bob Cunninghame has been busy planning the course and reports that all the checkpoints should be marked on the ground by the end of this week. Course vetter is Pete Squires. Everything is in place for a memorable and fun event.

Detailed information and entry forms are available on the NZRA website www.rogaine.org.nz . Be sure to get your entry in without delay. Closing date for entries is Friday 11th February.

Remember that, despite the title of NZ Championships, this event is for anyone who wishes to enter. It is not limited to elite athletes and there will be many ordinary mortals like you and me enjoying the chance to explore some extremely interesting country. Also remember that you do not have to be continuously out on course for the 24 hours. It is quite acceptable to visit the event centre for food and rest.

Need a partner? Alan Stow is looking for one. See "Partners Wanted" under the Event Calendar section of the website. If **you** are looking for a partner we may be able to help you find one. Send your details.

Other Events – be sure to regularly consult the Event Calendar at www.rogaine.org.nz for details and up-to-date information. Further events will be announced there as we get to know of them.

Wellington and New Plymouth Afterwork Series
For a series of 3hr afterwork events between 26th January and 16th March see the NZOF website at http://www.mapsport.co.nz/rog/rogevents.html .

T'Walk – This long-running historic (see the note below on its origins) event organised by the University of Canterbury Tramping Club will probably be in May.

Marlborough Rogaine – a date has been set for this: Saturday, 28th May. To be organised for the Marlborough Orienteering Club by Jut Bishop and Lachy Hynd. We have been assured by Mondo Kopua that this will be a superb event taking full advantage of the vast range of terrain for rogaine courses in Marlborough.

Heights of Winter – the date for this 12 hour event is Saturday 18th June. It will be organised by Peninsula and Plains Orienteers this year.

Australian Championships, May 2005

These are being organised by the Queensland Rogaine Association on a course close to the border with NSW. Kiwis are particularly welcome to partake. If you are planning to travel to the next World Champs in NSW in October 2006 the Queensland event would serve as a good introduction to Aussie terrain and conditions.
See http://www.qldrogaine.asn.au/ .

European Championships (2005) – are to be held in Estonia on 11-12th of June. A general invitation has been issued worldwide for Rogainers to partake. It would probably be a novel experience. The course would be somewhat unusual for Kiwis with the total height variation quoted as 30 meters on a map 1:50 000 with 5m contours. See the website at http://www.orion.ee/rogain/en/ .

Origins of Rogaining – Twalk and MUMC Anniversary

This year marks the 60th Anniversary of the Melbourne University Mountaineering Club which is credited as the originator of the twenty-four hour walks that developed into the sport of Rogaining. The first twenty-four hour walk was held in 1947 with 5 entrants in two teams. (One of the entrants became a partial member of both teams by swapping between teams whenever they met). The MUMC twenty-four hour walk became an annual affair.

In 1967 a Melbournite, Greg Martin, came to Canterbury University to study for a Masters degree in Electrical Engineering and quickly decided that Canterbury students were crazy enough to relish such an event. Hence T'walk was born and the event has run annually ever since. If you haven't already read it, see "Reminiscences on T'Walk" in the News Items section of the NZRA website.

For further information on the history of twenty-four hour walks and their evolution to Rogaining see the IRF website at http://www.rogaining.com/p2_history_det.html .

The Rewards of Breakfast or Disbelief in Good Fortune

Our esteemed treasurer, Bruce Meder, consumes about five Weetbix a day. He had a lot of empty cartons so he decided to post in the "Competition" forms from them. As a result he won a large 4WD Ford Explorer SUV worth about $50,000. After taking delivery it was some time before Bruce summoned up the courage to drive it – he couldn't believe it was actually his.

NZRA